

6 | YEAR OF REVIVAL

Political stability, the economy weathering a global crisis, Test cricket, slumdog millionaires; 2009 was not so bad after all.

10 | DEATH OF THE ALTERNATIVE

It was the year in which political dissent died, and even in death it was denied dignity. Only the politics of status quo could claim victory.

14 | IN THE BIG LEAGUE NOW

It was a whirlwind year, and except for the Sharm el-Sheikh stumble, India moved on to the high tables of global diplomacy.

18 | BHARAT BAILS OUT INDIA

The rural economy has helped boost consumption, investment and growth but sustenance requires serious reforms.

22 | THE REVENGE OF THE LITTLE PEOPLE

In the age of economic anxiety, TV and big screen audiences rejected stand-ins. Impostors were out and straight-from-the-heart stories were in.

26 | ENTER THE REVOLUTIONARY

If 2009 was the year of those who spurred revivals in their sports, 2010 needs those willing to support these soloists.

32 | THE YEAR WAS 140 CHARACTERS

From Twitter's pointless babble to the ego massages of social networks to TV's extremes, 2009 belonged to the digerati.

36 | IMAGES 2009

The UPA was back, the economy survived, there was cricket and Oscar history; 2009 was a year of renewal and hope.

70 VOICES

74 OBITUARY

78 HEROES AND VILLAINS

84 TOP 10

88 EYECATCHERS

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